

Mike Lyons

Engineering Leader

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I build the backend systems that power smart products, and I've owned them from 0 → 1 and 1 → 10. I love building things people love.

EXPERIENCE

hi finance
CTO / Co-Founder
May 2025 - Present

- Lead engineering as co-founder. Designed and built a custom **agent harness and software factory** that writes and ships its own code, so **1 engineer** and 2 operations staff run **three mobile apps, a web app, and an in-house CRM**.
- Shipped an AI grant application system that lets any university student claim student aid from their phone. Over **4,000 students** have used it to claim more than **$4M in funding**.

Stealth AI Startup
CTO / Co-Founder
Mar 2024 - May 2025

- Co-founded a pre-seed startup and raised **$2.5M** to bring AI/ML to commercial HVAC controls. Led all technical work and customer discovery.

Verkada
Head of Software, Intercom
2021 - Dec 2023

- Built and led the **8-engineer** software team that shipped the Intercom product line: **WebRTC audio/video** and access-control integration. Shipped in 9 months as Verkada's most successful new product launch, with **$14M in year one**.
- Before that: led the **re-architecture of the Access Control backend and firmware**, moving control logic and inference onto edge devices. The **Go rewrite** shipped to **thousands of live devices** and unblocked the next **4 Access product releases**.

Dor Technologies
Pre-Seed → Series A (Exited)
Head of AI/ML
Lead Systems Architect
Cofounder
2015 - 2021

- Built the **data pipeline and fullstack analytics platform** that processed **millions of events from thousands of edge ML devices** and powered Dor's customer analytics.
- Founding engineer through Series A and exit. Later hired, mentored, and led the AI/ML team as it grew to **10**.
- Built the data collection and labeling pipelines used to retrain production models.

Mark One / MyVessyl
Software Engineer
2014 – 2015

- Designed and built the **backend infrastructure** behind an AI-driven consumer hardware device.

Apple
Software Engineering Co-op
2013 - 2014

- Improved the scalability of the MDM product line, and built a fullstack JS application that turns hundreds of thousands of tickets into usable reports.

Earlier

- Technical Cofounder at CareerLabs (2015 – 2016). Software engineering intern at InstallNet & Aertight Systems, Annapolis MD (2011 – 2012).

OPEN SOURCE

Ness
Creator & Primary Author
Open Source | 2026 - Present

- An open-source IDE for coding with agents: parallel agent sessions across git worktrees, each with its own terminal, shell, and a browser the agent drives directly.